

Chapter 3 — Introduction to ethics and privacy

Chapter 2 asked how records enter a dataset

Learning objectives

- Distinguish ethics from privacy, name stakeholders affected across the dataset lifecycle
- Explain why compliance alone does not guarantee ethical practice

Why ethics and privacy matter now

- Data-driven systems shape decisions in healthcare, finance, marketing, and government
- As collection and use scale
- Misuse can enable identity theft, fraud, discrimination

Defining ethics and privacy

- In data work, ethics refers to principles that guide how data are collected, used, shared
- Privacy denotes individuals' rights to control personal data
- Ethics asks whether a use should proceed

Ethics versus privacy at a glance

- Ethics focuses on who is harmed or helped and whether uses are fair and accountable
- Privacy focuses on meaningful consent and individual control
- A team can be legally compliant yet ethically weak if uses are opaque or discriminatory

Lifecycle and stakeholders

- Documentation
- Stakeholders include practitioners, leaders, policymakers
- No single role owns the full obligation

Example 3.1 — Stakeholders in a wellness app launch

- Example 3.1 — hands-on module
- Example 3.1 compresses those roles into one product decision
- Product wants finer activity tracking
- Ethical design must negotiate utility, consent, and minimization together
- Explore the chapter example module
- View files: ``modules/chapter3/example1/``

Takeaways

- Ethics and privacy are distinct but mutually reinforcing
- Obligations span the full dataset lifecycle, not only deployment
- Ethical data work is coordinated across roles, utility, consent

Next

- Complete the quiz for this part
- Continue to the next part on core ethical principles